

SIGMA

TECHNOLOGY CLUB
IIM BANGALORE

PLACEMENT PREPARATION

SUMMER PLACEMENTS – TECHNOLOGY SECTOR

Edition 2017

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Amazon

Shreyas Joshi, Product Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
    a. Pre-process requirement is to write a one-pager Statement of Purpose (SOP) outlining which role you're applying to, and why you're a proper fit for the role – there's no predefined format but they check for a role-applicant fit and evaluate the SOP based on how closely it matches with Amazon's Leadership Principles
    b. There's no GD
    c. The number of interview rounds vary from person to person on a case-by-case basis. In my case, I only had one personal interview while others had 3-4 interviews. The average interview rounds are 2, where the first round is they decide which role you're a best fit for, and the next rounds are elimination rounds

2. **Does work experience matter?**
    a. Not in the strictest sense, but Amazon has a lot of roles to be offered (this year they came to campus with 9 roles)
    b. Each role has a preferred work experience, but they don't adhere to it strictly and are quite flexible with the exact duration of work experience.
    c. The interview is based on your work experience majorly if you have worked for 2+ years in the industry (not necessarily IT or Technology sector)

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
    PM Topics Covered: Behavioral
    a. The questions asked to me were more in the sense of "life-stories" wherein they check for the authenticity of the points written in SOP.
    b. Expect deep probing into any question that you're asked – how you displayed ownership, how you resolved conflicts and they do not want globe, in the sense that you should talk about something only if you have a certain level of involvement and expertise in the topic.
    c. The general area of focus is again trying to understand the kind of roles that interest you and they'll also suggest alternate teams that they think are a good fit for you, based on their preliminary analysis – it's important to know what you want and more importantly, what you DO NOT want.
    d. In my case, I was offered to be part of the MLDP role (Marketplace Leadership Development Programme), but since I was focused on Product Management, I explicitly told them the same. They do take into account personal preferences, but you need to justify your choices.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
    a. No HR questions were asked to me.
    b. For other candidates, HR questions mostly revolved around their SOP – the strengths and weaknesses that they listed.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
    a. The preparation should involve being up-to-date with latest happenings in the tech industry – particularly the e-commerce sector.
    b. Subscribe to newsletters provided by TechCrunch, Wired, Inc42, NextBigWhat and the like where you will know the latest technologies and their applications in various firms around the world.
    c. Important is to have interest in the technology field, although you may not have a ComputerSciencedegree.They'llcheckforauthenticityandfranknessintheinterviews.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
    a. Try to talk to PGP2s who have interned there, and match your expectations and demands before applying.
    b. The culture at Amazon is different as well, so if you're the sort of person who connects with that, and make your decision accordingly.
    c. Summers are one of the best ways to get into the company, and PPO rates vary but highly dependent on your personal potential.

Tulasi Vijaya Kumar, Product Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   Pre-Process Requirements: Once Amazon visits the campus and opens the roles they are going to offer at the summers, every candidate will be given an opportunity to opt for two roles out of the roles opened at the campus. Candidates must send SOPs for the roles they are applying for.
   GD: No GD.
   Rounds of Interviews: Depends on the first interview, the subsequent rounds will be decided. I had just one round. Amazon even took four rounds for some candidates. These interviews can be a blend of technical and HR.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, work experience matters at least for some of the roles offered like Product Management and Program Management. Apart from a couple of roles that were offered almost every role's job description mentioned work experience as desirable or made as part of eligibility criteria.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy, Guesstimates

   Case related to Amazon Prime was given to me to analyze the target segment, how to implement the Amazon Prime strategy in India in what geographies and what product categories are more appropriate to be covered by Amazon Prime. Interviewer summed up the discussion by asking a guesstimate on pricing of Amazon Prime. So it was more like a case interview where the primary emphasis was on structure, thought process, communication and conviction. Analytical thinking and problem solving is what Amazon looks for in candidates. You will be given a sheet of paper and interviewer will be looking at the end how systematically and structurally candidate approaches the problem.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**

   Once the case discussion came to an end there were questions on behavioral and situational based questions which are mostly related to HR. For candidates with work experience it is advisable to keep the incidents and experiences related to previous work experience ready as candidate will be tested with questions like 'incidents when you outperformed or solved a critical problem in the previous job'. Apart from this I was asked generic expected question such as strengths, personal life and professional background.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**

   Case preparation will come handy in case of Amazon interview. Candidate should be aware of the recent technical developments. One thing that impresses the interviewer for sure is linking answers to the Amazon's 12 Management Principles and ensuring they are embedded in answers.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**

   Know-how about Amazon, their recent acquisitions and new services they are coming up with like Amazon Pantry, Amazon Pay etc. Cases that are given by Amazon would be mostly the ones related to their product, about their website or the recent technical/business problem solved by them. So decent understanding about Amazon's products/services, business and Amazon's 12 Management Principles is what makes candidate interview-ready.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**

   PPO Policy: Yes (Yet to be released for last year summers)

   Internship experience and work culture: I did my internship in one of the most rampant growing areas of Amazon and was supported well by the Manager and the team. No long working hours (Flexible work-hours and work from home is possible) but candidate is expected to be accountable for the assignment being given. Most of the candidates were given more than one project so planning from Day 1 is quintessential for completing the project on time and to avoid running from pillar to post in the pursuit of meeting stakeholders of the project. Candidate has to be good at written communication as everything including new business plans/product or feature launches will be presented only in the form of a 6-page narrative and PPTs are not in use. So the successful PPO conversion depends a lot on writing concise, effective and data-driven narrative which is the desired form for final project report of summer internship.

Jayakumar P, Product Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   You have to apply for a maximum of 5 roles out of the 9-11 roles on offer and a direct shortlist comes on the basis of resume and SOP which you fill for each role. Ideally your resume should focus on data and customer obsession.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Work experience does not matter as such but having a technological experience works in your favor in some roles.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Root Cause Analysis, Product Strategy, Metrics
   I was given 2 problems faced by Amazon and had to propose the solution for the same. The first problem revolved around pricing the Amazon Prime and the second problem was to check for complaints on Amazon and propose metrics to be considered for the same. Generally, the problem revolves around issue faced by Amazon

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   No HR questions were asked

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Do not believe in framework and just focus a lot on your problem-solving skills and issues pertaining to technology in the world.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Just keep calm in your interview and address every problem given by the interviewer in a logical way.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   You are solely interacting with mentor as all the other people are too busy with their tasks. It gives you a chance to explore into other domains as well.
   Yes, there is a PPO policy with around 30% interns who get PPO.

Vandana, Product Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   Amazon's process is very simple. Just had to apply on the PlaceCom portal. The shortlist was released on the GD day at 2am at night. The placement process started at 8am. The process was twofold. First, there was 20-30min HR round. Then there was a technical round.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   It does matter. They did not say that explicitly. But, I felt that they prefer people with experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy
   In the technical round, they told me about a recommendation kind of plan and asked how would I go about it. It mostly involved marketing concepts. This may vary with the products they ask about. Not much of technical knowledge is required if you have a basic understanding of marketing concepts. I think they expect very straightforward and honest answers.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   They asked questions like “Tell me more about yourself”, “Tell about a kind of situation that you faced”, “Why do you want to join the company?”, “If you have to come up with a product what would it be?” etc. They basically want to know whether you have understood the job description correctly and whether you fit in the company. They may pick out a few things from your CV and ask about what were the learnings, challenges etc. from that etc.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Knowing about the products of the company is very important. If you have some contacts inside the company then ask them about recent happenings there. Understanding of the product management role is important. There are many other roles like category manager, program manager etc. which might create confusion and you might deviate from the role while being in the interview itself. You should know the scope and boundaries of product management.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Not with respect to only Amazon, I think guesstimate is one topic which everyone should prepare not only for consults because it can be used for your analysis. I used it even in my Microsoft GD.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   The objective and goals in Amazon are very customer-centric. Your suggestions are expected to be simple and you should always keep the customers in your mind. The way of writing is very different. You should create 6-page documents which are unique in structure instead of presentations. If you get selected make sure that you learn that very quickly. People are very busy with their work there and you should be proactive and ask for time if you need some information. The PPO list is not out yet.

Jonaki Biswas, BoldOps

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   Firstly, a cover letter is required stating your intention to work for Amazon on the lines of the company values. There are 8 verticals and one had to give their 3 preferences as per the notification. After the GD day, the shortlist is announced and direct interview takes place

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   There are some roles that require more than 2 years of experience like BOLD which will be stated in the JD sent by PlaceCom. The interview is based on work experience, they would not check each point on your resume, but would like to listen to a story form of all your works till date. And lot of emphasis is laid on your previous work experience while shortlisting/selecting and even while assigning the project.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Behavioral
   Amazon is too particular about their 14 leadership principles. If one has Amazon as their dream company, he/she should learn and internalize those 14 principles and try to reflect as many principles as possible in their answers. Few principles like customer centric approach, deep dive, simplify and execute, frugality, are preferred over others which they feel are possible with time and experience, like 'Hire good/ right people'.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Tell something about yourself.
   Since, my role was BOLD, which was related to people management, they asked me about how will I handle a team which performs monotonous job continuously. How will I incentivize them and ensure their best performance?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   The 14 leadership principles are must for anyone targeting Amazon. They are available online, if not, any Amazon intern has a diary which has them. Reach out to them instantly.
   These 14 principles are almost self-explanatory and will easily guide Pgp1 how to go for the interview. Mostly them look for customer centric approach, deep dive, bias for action, back any theory with facts etc.
   Have knowledge about SQL, they are very much fact driven, and SQL is the software to mine data. So, it's an additional point if you know SQL.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Interviewers are cool people; people like us who graduated might be 3 to 4 years before us. Keep your cool, be relaxed and follow the 14 principles.
   Once you get the internship, during the internship try to get the project charter as early as possible. Managers will be busy, keep reaching out to them continuously. Also, focus on report right from the beginning.

7. How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?

The induction was not that smooth. They conduct orientation of permanent hires and Interns together and most of the thing on that day seems useless.

The work culture is really very good. People are cooperative. Less bureaucracy. No formals required. Flexible timings. One should just focus on his/her deliverables and be in contact with the mentor and manager all the time.

The reviews and feedbacks conducted were good but people are really busy at times and it becomes really tough to get hold of people you need to execute your project.

I personally did not like the role/project I got. But I could have done better within the scope I was given.

PPO not released till now. But 30% conversion was there for the PGP3s I guess.

Amit Kumar, Program Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   Amazon verticals: Program, Product, Bold Ops, MLDP (Like Gen-Man), Category, Finance Role
   No GD
   SOP: Was separate for all verticals. Should show your obsession. Inclination for data.
   Amazon Program Management: Developed entire operational program. Launch + Sellers + Customers + Product = Complete Ecosystem
   2 rounds of interviews (Some people had 1 or 3)

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   A bit. They prefer practical understanding. 14-principle thought process. 1st one is customer obsession. That should be there in all your answers.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Metrics, Guesstimate
   Guestimate: Suppose Amazon launching in S.A. What should be the call-centre capacity? Best thing in your last firm. Inventory Classification. Resource Prioritization. (OM Questions)
   Previous work-ex, Guestimates was the focus of interview.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   What did you do in IIMB. Anything special you did in college. Pitch anything unique that you have in your profile. Something that your boss declined but you did and got success. From CV, asked about achievements and explanations.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Read Supply Chain properly. How the entire marketplace model works. Read through last 4-5 months of news related to Amazon, like Seller-Flex Program, Chai-Cart.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Align your previous work-ex with requirements and Ecommerce future.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   Experience was good. Varies from team to team. A lot of data intensive approach. 9:30 AM to 7 PM. Bangalore location. They give transport from accommodation. You could have arrangements for flexi-timings if required. If you want to work on a lot of things, resources will always be there.
   PPO still haven't come. It generally comes late, around Mid-October. Generally, to 40-50% of people.

Abhishek Ghosh, Program Manager

1. **What was your role at Amazon?**
   Program Manager

2. **How many interns were totally hired?**
   20 from IIM Bangalore

3. **Is there a PPO at the end of internship in this role? How many?**
   Historically, the conversion rate for PPO is around 40%. (No PPO were rolled out until the time this interview was taken)

4. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, the work experience matters. Database management and data analysis are sort after by Amazon. A background in programming is usually an advantage. Languages used in Amazon are Python, R and SQL.

5. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general focus of the interview?**
   PM Topics Covered: Behavioral
   Amazon has no GD or written test. Every shortlisted candidate gets a chance at interview. Multiple profiles are offered and only 2 profiles can be applied for.

   Amazon is excessively focused on its leadership principles (google them) and is looking for candidates that are a cultural fit in that framework. Most of the questions asked are stories from past experiences (life as well as work ex). All these stories are then fit in the leadership framework by the interviewer on-spot. The interview is very informal and chilled out. The interviewers are usually team-mates that you will be working with.

   Apart from experiences, scenario-based cases are given (same as consulting cases). Usually, no general knowledge questions are asked. Recent advances in technology are also not asked.

6. **Any tips for preparations**
   Learn Amazon's leadership framework and weave stories around them. If possible, prepare a suggestion to pitch to them regarding Amazon's services. Of course, do not pitch your suggestion directly but push it in between conversation.

7. **What was your project title at Amazon? Some description of the project.**
   Amazon does not provide a proper title for the project. Rather a minimal charter is given on the work to be done. You can create your own title like I made – "Shipment Traffic Flow Visualization Module". The project was into last mile product and services. The task was to prepare tools which can help in forecasting and visualization. The manager was from Business Intelligence domain. The project is still in progress.

8. **How was your experience at Amazon? Company Culture? Quality of work? Senior management exposure?**
   Mixed experience at Amazon. There is a lot of learning but at the same time, work is usually hectic. There are flexible work hours and no dress code. Entrepreneurship culture prevails and each individual is given full ownership of the project. There is no hand holding by manager or

peers. Amazon follows an open office culture. Everyone is accessible, both formally and informally. Quality of work is good and all successful projects are directly implemented. All resources of the company are at your disposal and you are treated like a full-time employee.

My team consisted of 3 individuals and one more joined while I was working there. The team was created afresh for the project. All teammates were industry experienced but new at Amazon.

No project will contain two interns so there is usually no clash. Also, there is no fixed quota for PPO roll-outs each year. If the whole batch is good, it will be absorbed.

9. **Any tips for PGP1's who will be joining Amazon for summer internship.**
   Same as previous answer.

10. **Is there any buddy or mentor program at Amazon?**
    No mentor is allotted before joining. After joining, a buddy is allocated. But, if you get a busy person as buddy, he/she will be of no use.

    All the best for summers.

Mayur Vikani, Program Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   Two steps (effectively three for the Program Management Role):
   1. Résumé submission along with a letter of intent.
   2. Personal Interview (2 rounds for Program Management Role)

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Requirement for Work Ex is role dependent. For Program Management, a work ex of 2-4 years was preferred.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy
   Round 1: Diverse set of questions (nothing from my résumé, the interviewer clearly mentioned at the start of the interview that questions will not be from my resume points) ranging from optimization of inbound process for their warehouse to pricing strategy for 'Amazon Prime'.
   Round 2: Questions started with my résumé points, the interviewer asked in detail about some of them, mostly work ex points. Followed by a case study.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Nothing in specific was asked. But they were assessing required HR qualities in PI itself. Every question had some element of HR/ Amazon's guiding principles in it.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**

1. Be thorough with your résumé points and your learnings from those points.
2. Go thorough Amazon's guiding principles and try to relate your learning to those principles.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   1. DO NOT provide any answer/display a behavior indicating an opposite philosophy to their principles.
   2. Be open in your approach while answering the questions in PI, it's okay to accept the flaw in your argument and correct it accordingly.
   3. Solve cases (basic frame works).

Vignesh S, Program Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**

   No GD or case submission. However, applicants were required to submit a letter of intent for each role they apply for. Amazon offered roles in 9 domains. A candidate could apply for a maximum of 5. I had submitted copies of the same letter of intent for all 5 roles.

2. **Does work experience matter?**

   Work ex (> 2 years) was a prerequisite for some roles like BOLD ops, Business Development, Capacity Planning.

   However, no work ex was required for certain roles, for ex: Category Management

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   PM Topics Covered: System Design, Behavioral

   There were 3 interviews:

   I was informed of my selection after round 2. The third was possibly just to determine which role I would best fit in (I was offered BOLD operations despite interviewing primarily for program and product management – I had no prior operations experience).

   In the first interview, I was initially asked questions related to my projects during my work (I had worked in a tech role): details of an algorithm I implemented etc. Then I was asked to plan personnel requirements for a customer service center to handle defects/delivery related issues. Another question was to give ideas regarding location of fulfilment centers in India.

   The second interview was largely HR based – about situations where I had to convince people, instances where I overcame obstacles in achieving something. I was offered the job after this interview.

   The third interview was also mostly HR – similar questions to the 2nd interview asked by a different person. I was also asked one question where the interviewer asked me to define metrics for a prospective quality monitoring initiative by Amazon Post this, they asked me if I would be interested in the operations role instead of program management as they felt I was a better fit there.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**

   Give me an instance where you had to manage/convince people to agree to your point of view. How did you go about doing so?

   One instance where you had to overcome significant obstacles in achieving something.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**

   Be prepared to answer basic questions on operations, planning and tech (if you have tech experience) even if they are not the primary role you are applying for. The questions were not too complicated and the interviewer offers help when one is stuck. A fair idea about the concepts covered in the first half of the operations course in term 2 would probably suffice. Even the ops related questions were logical and not concept oriented.

   Going prepared with standard HR questions (mentioned before) helped me. Before the interview I would recommend looking up Amazon's leadership principles for about 10 mins and aligning answers to any situation based questions with them. I learned much later that the company follows these principles religiously and the interviewers rate the candidates based on the principles.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**

   Amazon did not seem to expect deep knowledge in the domain you apply for. They tested basic knowledge in multiple domains and your general problem-solving approach. However, this was just my experience and might not have been the same for others.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**

   Internship Experience: Great insights into the scale and complexity of the business. The work experience, however, depends a lot on the team you are assigned to. Different interns had very different experiences. Some liked it and others didn't.

   Work Culture: Life at the company is fairly hectic (10-12 hours a day), but a lot of freedom is given to managers. Heard there is a lot of flexibility in terms of being able to switch domains/teams within Amazon.

   PPO Policy: no announcement yet

Ankit Kumar, MLDP

MLDP: Marketplace Leadership Development Program: It is kind of a General management kind of profile in Amazon where after final placement (if PPO or otherwise), you will be rotated across product/program management, marketing management and business development roles in Amazon. During Internship, any one of the roles will be given.

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**

   Steps:

   Only one – Direct Interview. For others, there were two interviews but for me only one.

   There were following profiles:

   - Amazon - Bold Operations Intern
   - Amazon - Business Development Management
   - Amazon - Capacity Planning Analyst
   - Amazon - Category Management
   - Amazon - Financial Analyst
   - Amazon - Marketing Management
   - Amazon - MLDP
   - Amazon - Product Management
   - Amazon - Program Management

   But we could max apply for 5. We had to submit Letter of Intent (Kind of equivalent to a cover letter with content objectives of your reasoning for applying to respective profile). I had created a generic Letter of Intent for Amazon profiles as such and had submitted for all the profiles I applied for.

2. **Does work experience matter?**

   Not sure. Maybe little bit.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   PM Topics Covered: Behavioral

   My interview was surrounded fully related to my experiences and related leadership experiences. Since I had one interview, I am combining the answer to the next question also here. Some of the questions I can recollect are:

   1. Tell me about yourself
   2. From my job experience, what exactly was my role in one of the project where it was about process improvement.
   3. What was my biggest achievement in my previous job? (Use the simple way – set the example scenario and give proper reasoning on how it is)
   4. Tell an experience where you didn't agree with your manager. How did you go about it?
   5. As a follow up question – Is informal relations always helpful in business? What was your reaction of your manager on using an informal route for that specific task?

6. Why MLDP role? Follow up question on how do you connect it with your long-term goal (as I had connected it in my answer)
7. Any suggestions for Amazon India to improve its market share in India?

Basically, the whole interview was built up on how I went on with my answers.

4. What kind of HR questions were asked?

Answered this question in the above part.

5. How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?

As per previous batch and some of my classmate's interviews, I would still suggest you to do following:

1. Practice HR questions properly. Have 1-2 answers for most of the basic questions. Make sure Tell me about yourself helps you to kick start our interview in a good way (i.e. include something about your characteristic and tie up with your work ex / hobby / anything else!)
2. Go through Amazon's 14 leadership principles and see if you can connect your HR answers to them if asked in a direct or indirect way (Like in my case, I think they assessed it in an indirect way)
3. Go through Amazon site, latest news etc. Keep in mind 1-2 points which you feel can be improved in site or in the process in general. Similarly, any new suggestions which could help Amazon.
4. Before interview, it will be good if you can be prepared with one question for interviewer also!
5. Practice some guestimates and check out some basic cases.
6. Attend GD and mock interviews conducted by Focal and Sigma.

Resources: company site, blogs, Techcrunch, newspapers (Mint is good)

6. Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:

Few things which I learned during the process and I feel should be kept in mind during preparation and during the D-day:

1. Network and be in touch with PGP2s especially if they have interned in the companies which you are interested in. Have connect with your PR and other coordinators. Summers is not a stabilized process as you will think of and these will be helpful both in your prep and during the process.
2. Do not apply everywhere! Apply as per your interest but don't be too selective too. Prepare a priority chart and prepare well in advance for company info for at least top 5-10 companies. This will help ease last minute rush for preparation.
   For tech preparation, follow latest trends.

3. I had prepared for Microsoft also (though I couldn't get shortlisted for GD). So as per my classmates and my seniors, GD is one of the deciding point for MS. Hence know about the products about MS and the previous GD topics as similar ones can repeat. Similarly solve the case for Directi which they ask at the time of application. They will shortlist almost all the people who have submitted the case. If you have done good work in case solution, your chances might be high.
4. Also, note that Google has ditched in past two years, beware of it! And other tech companies come in at a time where most of your classmates would have been placed. So, don't keep waiting for those companies as some unexpected surprises can happen at that time! (Hopefully if there are changes in process, there will be better distribution of such companies)
5. Finally, be calm and confident on the interview day (like I always suggest everyone to shake hands with interviewers as you first meet them). After you are placed, be there and help others in a non-sympathetic way! Remember everyone here has enough capability to land a good job. It is just that the random nature of process and the peer pressure environment makes it harder for some. So be there to support your friends!

Microsoft

Harendra Prasad, Microsoft IDC, Program Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   After shortlist is out, GD is conducted in which you have to solve a problem. I had got the problem of application of AI in Microsoft Office. Followed by the GD round, you are called for the interview. I had 2 interviews before I got selected for the same

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No, work experience does not matter. You should be aware of the technology around and have a passion for technology to apply for the company

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy
   I was asked to devise a mechanism for recommendations given on YouTube and the process in which the videos are monetized. In addition I was even asked about the AR/VR mechanism in payment softwares. No general area of focus. The interviewer could ask any question pertaining to technology and not specific to Microsoft

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   No HR questions were asked to me.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Keep abreast with the technology and your vocabulary should be from a technical aspect more so than a MBA person

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Be prepared with fundamentals of technology and how these are impacting the world.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   In Microsoft, it is logic that prevails and the internship experience depends to a great extent on your mentor and there is a PPO policy as well.

Puja Bardhan, Microsoft IDC, Program Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   Resume Shortlist > GD (which was like 10 people seated in groups of 2. The groups were moderated by 4-5 PMs. It was individual design work that we had to explain to the PM separately) > Interview Round 1 with a senior PM > Interview Round 2 with a Director.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Both freshers and experienced candidates got offers so I believe it does not matter. However, in my case, I was asked about my work.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: App Critique, Product Design
   In the GD round, we were asked to pick any MS Office product and come up with a feature for it. We had to explain what the feature would do and the rationale behind picking that particular feature.
   In the first round of interview, I was asked to design a feature palette for Paytm. Again, the same thing why did I pick it etc. Then I was asked a few basic computer science questions about sorting. In this round, I was also asked about a few points from my resume those were related to the initiatives I took.
   In the second round of interview, I was asked about my work experience, how did I bring a difference. Here, I was asked to come up with new product features for any company that I liked. I had picked Uber. Then, a few database control related questions.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   I did not have any HR round.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Be up-to-date with all the recent happenings in the tech world. Definitely read the book "Cracking the PM Interview" by McDowell and Bavaro.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Being from Computer Science and Engineering background would help a lot. Read up about all the recent happenings in the tech world. Pick a few companies and their products, understand existing features (good and bad) and think of new features that can be added.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   It was a great learning experience. Their PPO policy is very good. Conversion rate is quite high as compared to many other firms.

Ananth, Microsoft IDC, Program Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   There's an initial 'GD' round, which is more of a group ideation session. You are given a task, ours was to ideate a feature for a PDA (think Cortana, Siri, Assistant). You have to think it out end to end, from describing the feature to the metrics that you will use to evaluate the success of this feature. The moderators will come periodically and you have to explain whatever you have thought out to them, and they will give suggestions. At the end you submit the paper you wrote everything on.
   I had one interview round.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   It does help in the GD shortlist, but beyond that it doesn't matter.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: System Design
   My interview was focused towards designing a system for access control (a topic that had come up while I was discussing my profile with the interviewer). What matters is your ability to think structured and from a macro perspective when answering. And another thing is to always keep your cool. My interviewer constantly rebutted everything I said, but a combination of lack of sleep and exhaustion meant I kept a smiling face throughout the process, which probably helped :)

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   None specifically.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Read cracking the pm interview for understanding the PM role. Keep up to date with the latest happenings in tech through the Techcrunch, Flipboard, etc. Start thinking about tech design in a structured manner, and how to design products people will love.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   All the best for summers! Try to figure out what you would like to do, and work towards that. Like all things, this too will pass!

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   Internship was great. I was in charge of one vertical of a new product we were creating for Azure. So my work involved understanding the customer and their pain points, creating hypothesis based on this, conducting customer interviews to validate hypothesis, or modify them. Based on this, creating a demo working with the developers and designers, and creating design mockups for additional use cases.
   Work culture is great. You don't get mothered to get things done. You're given deliverables and corresponding deadlines, and as long as you deliver, they don't bother whether you're there for 14 hours or 8. Plus no pompous dress codes! :)

PPO just depends on how well you deliver, it is not relative to your performance compared to others. The previous year's conversion rate was 33%, and this year it was greater than 50%, so your fate is entirely in your hands!

Gokul, Microsoft IDC, Program Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   The initial GD round was an individual problem-solving session. Everyone in that panel got the same question and we had to independently solve that problem on a piece of paper. Our question for our panel was how to improve market share for EDGE browser. I think we also had to come up with 2 features that would lead to a certain % increase in share in the next 5 years. You need to be extremely structured in your approach and you are evaluated based on how you analyze the problem all the way up to the metrics you come up with to evaluate your recommendation. Metrics are super important for Microsoft.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Both freshers and experienced candidates got offers so I believe it does not matter.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Metrics, Guesstimate
   I don't believe there is one specific type of question asked in these interviews. Each one of us had different experiences and it completely depends on who interviews you. Having said that: My first round of interview was a mixture of HR+Quants. I was asked questions from DS1/DS2. Thorough understanding of probability distributions (normal/binomial), hypothesis testing and some LP basics from DS2 would go a long way if you find yourself in such situations. I was asked something along the lines of how to test if a dice is a fair die. We also had a detailed discussion about my work-ex which was on building algorithmic stock trading systems at Citi. The interviewer asked – given a sum of $10,000, how/where I would invest to maximize return in 1 year (assuming the investment client is 100% risk-seeking). This was clearly an LP optimization problem from DS2. So, be prepared for odd questions like that.
   My second-round interview was more of a typical PM round. The interviewer asked me to design and launch "Uber for Kids" in a city of my choice in India. This was a fairly detailed question where I had to choose a market based on heuristics and guesstimates. It also involved lengthy discussion on consumer journey map, pain points, features, design, metrics etc. for how this app would work. Towards the end, I was also asked another question - assuming I was the PM for Azure, how I would deal with potential scaling issues during unforeseen events such as demonetization.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   I was asked a fair number of HR questions in my first round of interview. Since I had a 4-year fin+tech background pre-MBA at Citi, they were doubting why I didn't pursue day 0 options. So, it took some effort convincing them why I was passionate about the PM role and why I wanted a career switch at this point in time. In general, it is good to be prepared for questions such as why PM, what is a PM, why Microsoft etc.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Cracking the PM interview is a great place to start the prep. Keep up to date with things happening in the sector – Techcrunch, Flipboard, Inc etc. are good sources. Structured thought process and customer empathy are what they mainly test more than the technical know-how. In general, it is good to prepare for questions around product design (add new feature/use cases), go-to-market strategy for a new product, system design, estimations, metrics etc. The book recommended above again is a great source to practice such problems.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Keep your calm and look positive in the interview. It is the number one trait they expect from a PM . Also, show a hefty dose of passion for tech and the possibilities it presents for the future. Keeping abreast with things happening in tech is definitely a must if you are serious about this sector.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   I loved my experience at MS IDC Bangalore. I was the only one from IIMB to intern in the Bangalore office. There was one of each from IIM A, B and C in the Bangalore office vis-à-vis IDC Hyderabad which had like 15 odd interns. Though this was initially pretty scary (partly due to FOMO), soon it turned out to be a pretty good thing. I loved the small Bangalore office which gave me great visibility in terms of access to senior leaders. The folks who come to campus for Microsoft PM Day, Recruitment etc. are all from the Bangalore office. So, you get to meet them again once you start interning! The Bangalore team size is pretty small compared to Hyderabad. This means that if you do well, you immediately get the recognition from across board (Sr. management in IDC as well as the US). I think this kind of exposure can be hard to come by in large offices.
   Plus, the weather in Bangalore in May is to kill for as compared to IDC Hyderabad (imagine 40 odd degrees)!

   I had interned in the Office 365 team. It is one of the verticals that is rapidly growing today in India. So, there was a lot of exciting stuff happening at the time I was there. The project I worked on was pretty technically oriented and it would have been quite difficult had I not come from a tech background. Work culture at Microsoft is amazing. You are given a lot of autonomy and not constantly hand-held. You also get daily/weekly mentoring sessions from your mentor and manager. These timely feedback sessions helped keep track of progress and what I was doing wrong/right. PPO completely depends on your individual performance and how well you deliver. You are certainly not competing with your fellow interns for the PPOs. Each one is evaluated individually. The PPO conversion rate is generally pretty good for Microsoft .

Manjula A, Microsoft SMSG

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   We had a GD of about 30-40 min. We were given a case of about 3 pages and were asked to read it for 10 min. Post which we had the GD for 30 min. The GD topic was How to sell Microsoft Azure to Small and Medium Businesses in India. Based on that 10-12 were shortlisted out of 60

members after the GD. Some of us had only one interview while others had two interviews, based on where the HR sits. If you are assigned to a panel with HR you have only one interview. Or else you have another HR interview.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes. In our batch of 15 interns from different IIMs everyone had a work experience. From IIM Bangalore they took people with Analytics/IT background. But from other IIMs there were interns from other backgrounds as well.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Execution
   I have experience in Analytics and most of the interview revolved around my experience. It was pre-dominantly about digital marketing. They also asked questions about how do you handle customers. Personally, for me the game changer was when they asked me if I have any questions for them, I asked very good questions on whatever I had analyzed about the company. It is always good to read about the recent things that Microsoft is doing, not just on the business front but also on the CSR front. They were very impressed with my questions and they asked me if I were to implement it how would I go about it.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   The HR questions were more about work experience like “Have you ever faced any difficult situation with the client and how did you tackle”. In my work experience I had interacted with people from Singapore, Japan, Australia etc. I was asked about the differences I experienced while working with people from different cultures. There were no questions specifically about goals etc.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   It is advisable to know about Microsoft company since it will be useful for product management also. Also, a little preparation about the company structure should be good. The divisions in the company and how do they work across functions. Other than that, for a sales and marketing role the general marketing preparation should help specific to digital marketing.
6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Try to focus on only the sectors you are interested. Targeting all the sectors will put you under a lot of stress and you will not be able to go in depth in any on domain during your preparation. If anyone is interested in technology, try to read more about recent technology.
7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**

   The people at Microsoft are very helpful. All the details were clearly communicated. We were given our project details 2 days prior to joining. We had 3 days of induction where the top-level people from all over the country had come. That gave us an understanding of how the company works. We were allotted live projects. I could see the results of my work immediately. Some interns were supposed to travel across cities and interact with customers. I travelled within the city a few times to talk to some stakeholders. Overall it was a good experience. There is a PPO policy.

InfoEdge

Prince Jain, Product Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   There was no GD for PM role. There was only one round of interview for InfoEdge. FMCG IT roles have GD.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No. But if you have work experience it is an advantage. If you have not worked before they will just check your understanding of the role.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioral
   It depends whether you have a work experience or not. If you have a work experience then you will be asked to describe your role. They also asked what is PM according to you to check your understanding of the role you have applied to. You should go through the profile that they are offering and about the company. They also asked about any product that you have used and any feature you would like to add in that product. They may also ask to come up with a new product that will benefit Indians. Questions like "Why this company?" also might be asked. Some companies also ask questions regarding how you handled issues during your work experience.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   There was only on round of interview and there was no HR in the panel.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Prepare the general questions mentioned above. Every company asks those questions. Also keep yourself updated with the latest trends in technology. Start following news blogs for around 10-15 min every day.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Focus on what you want to do. Rather than preparing for all the domains prepare for maximum two domains. Meet PGP2s who have interned in that sector for guidance.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   The work culture is very good. They have a startup culture though it is no more a startup. They just wanted you to do your work within the deadlines. It does not matter where you work from. Employees were very helpful and provided me with whatever resources I needed. We were assigned two mentors. I could approach them anytime whenever I was stuck. InfoEdge does not offer any PPOs or PPIs to IIMB students.

Directi

Mehul Khot, Product Manager

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   There was a case submission 1 week before the summer placements. The case was to about google Adwords. There was no GD. Shortlist for interview was based on resume and case submission. There were 2 interviews one was technical and the other was technical + HR.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Work experience is preferable. Coding skills are not required. You should have understanding of technology.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy
   I was asked about the working of Uber from user side and as well as from developer side. Also about the surge pricing and how they communicate this to the drivers. I was also asked about any area of user. The other questions were related to networking and web servers. I was also asked about online advertising and how revenues are earned.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Due to lack of time I was not asked any HR questions.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Attend Tech GDs conducted by FOCAL. Case prep related to any new technology and how it will impact the market. Follow TechCrunch for latest technology updates.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Be cool and balance academics and placement preparation. Take 2-3 hours a day to read the news and also for case prep. Discuss cases in groups and attend GDs.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   My role was about Digital Advertising. My project was cross device tracking to track the different devices used by the same user. The work culture is the best you can have. Recreation room on the same floor, bean bags, free food etc. makes it one of the best tech companies to work in India. Yes, there is a PPO Policy.

Cognizant Business Consulting

Pamela Mandal, IT Consultant

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   There was no GD. The shortlist was based on the video resume that we had submitted. There was were 2 technical interview rounds and 1 HR interview round.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, it was mentioned in their JD about the required work experience. They look for people having IT work experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   I was asked about my previous work experience. I was also asked one guestimate question. And they also gave me details about the role at internship. In the next round also, I was asked more details about my work experience. They were trying to match your work experience with their projects.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   HR round was based on the PORs and extra curriculars on my resume.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Read a lot about Tech. Understand what the company is all about and what role they are offering. Try to align your interest with the company's interest. Also solve some guestimates. Have an idea about your work experience. Be thorough with what is on your resume. Case preps can be done but intensive preparation is not required.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Balance both classes and preparation. Focus on what the company is all about. That's where they come to know if you are really interested in their company. Align your skillset with their expectations. Keep calm and be focused.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   I was based out of Kolkata. I had one mentor and a director with whom I had to interact. My project was about robotics. My mentor used to guide me well. The work culture was good. Yes, they have a PPO policy.

Asian Paints

Anuradha, IT Intern

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   There was 1 GD: Entrepreneurship Vs. Managerial Work; How much of entrepreneurship is instinctive and how much is theoretical knowledge.
   No. of Interviews: 1 (HR + Tech Combined)
   No Pre-process. You can't decide your vertical. They do it and interview for that vertical.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No, it doesn't matter. But if you have it, it definitely helps. Identify some key contributions and explain about them in detail.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   They were judging the conviction over the HR questions. Also, General Awareness over technology was tested.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**

   - Is it good to always have consensus in a team or conflicts are good?
   - Is outcome more important or the process.?
   - They asked to explain the terms spoken in GD.
   - Define IoT in 3 words. How will you use it in Paints.?
   - How do you use IoT in Healthcare? Explain various other use-cases.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Focal GDs. Sessions from different company PGP2's. Mock interviews
   - Flipboard/Tech Crunch.
   - Reading Tech news.
   - Knowing what the business model of a company is. Read esp. about unique business models like YouTube.
   - Read about Lean Canvas.
   - Read about the products of each of them.
   - Blockchain

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:** None

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   I interned in IT in Manufacturing and Analytics domain. It was more of a consulting kind of work. My work involved taking business requirements from operations and conveying to vendors. Work culture depends on the project you are working on. It can be hectic or not too hectic depending on the projects.
   PPO policy was good. ½ from IT and 1/3 from Marketing got PPOs.

Aswathy A, IT Intern

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   The applicants had to fill an online application form consisting of basic HR questions. Few students were shortlisted for the GD. The topic was 'Security lies in structure; in chaos lies challenges.' The shortlisted candidates had to face one round of interview which consisted of HR questions.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Not at all! I am a fresher.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   The interview was more or less centered around HR questions. They discussed about the GD topic and wanted to know if I had anything to add on to it. Out of the box thinking is appreciated. They want to know you as a person and whether you will really fit into this role. They asked me about why I want to come into IT, few innovations in IT which I find interesting and how IT can be applied to any sector to make a difference. Showing the passion is really important.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   HR questions centered around knowing about myself and my interest in IT.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Practice GDs well. Out of the box thinking is very important. Also, prepare the HR questions well. You should know why you are sitting there for their interview.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Be yourself in the interview and the GD. Find that fine balance b/w assertiveness and aggression in GDs.

P&G

Manish Mishra, IT Intern

1. **What was your role at P&G and what were the job responsibilities?**
   My role at P$G was that of Summer Intern – IT.
   The job responsibility was managing the vendor who was responsible was taking care of one of the major IT processes related to business reporting. I was given the complete ownership of the project to carry it on my own as I wished to. It involved going through the complete process in detail, finding out the inefficiencies by doing VSM study, giving recommendations and associated savings. Also, they were planning to move to a new platform. So, it was my responsibility to come up with a saving figure which would be used for negotiating the contract with the vendor. It also involved alignment of few roles which had various overlapping functions as their roles and responsibilities. Overall, it was a great experience managing multiple stakeholders across multiple geographies.

2. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Pre-Processing rounds: P and G has several pre-processing rounds which are common for all the functions. It consists of a psychometric test followed by a logical reasoning test.
   GD: GD is the place where you can leave an impact on the recruiters. They had 1 GD round which was a case based GD.
   Interviews: I had 3 rounds of interviews where mostly HR related questions were asked and they tried to judge the leadership and decision-making capabilities.

3. **Does work experience matter?**
   Not really. However, for this role, they would prefer someone who has some tech background in one form or the other.

4. **What kind of questions were you asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   GD was the place where they mostly judge your business and technical acumen. P and G as a company gives a lot of emphasis to the cultural fit. So interviews are mainly to judge that. For me, interviews were mainly HR based only where they had asked for several instances of my life where I had managed conflicts, led a team etc. They would delve deeper into whatever you mention as a response to those questions, whether it be during your work ex or some college projects. So, be genuine with your answers.

5. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Instances where you had led a team, instances where you had managed a conflict, instances where you brought some major change in the functioning of the things etc.

6. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   For general PM roles, be thorough with the latest technological developments and whatever is happening currently in the technology sector. Follow the news related to companies' latest developments. For FMCG companies, be aware of the product portfolio. Use resources such as

Techcrunch, Mashable, Nextbigthing etc. Read about the sector in which the company deals in thoroughly.

7. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Be clear with the list of companies which are your top priorities. Focus on what all are they currently doing with respect to technology and how can new technologies be used to make things better. Fresh ideas are always welcome.

8. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   Internship experience was great and it gave a lot of exposure to how post-MBA jobs would be. I was given the complete ownership of my project and there was no micromanagement at all. Work culture was great where everyone was willing to support whenever you ask for any help. Out of 3 interns P&G had taken for IT role, 1 intern got a PPO.

Sayak Sarkar, IT Intern

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   Initially there will be a psychographic test and then the shortlisted candidates will have an aptitude test. Then people shortlisted from this round will have a GD. GD will be conducted along with 3 people and at the end panelist will ask individual questions. People selected will get an interview call which will be followed by 3 rounds of interviews.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Work experience matters for IT. Also, the GD case will be technical, so having relevant work experience will definitely give the candidate an edge over others.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Mostly all the 3 rounds will be HR based. They won't test your technical knowledge here. Be pretty much clear why do you want to get into IT. Justify your answers with your own life experiences. You can be asked a question where you can be asked a situation where you exhibited leadership skills – do back it up with real life experiences in office or sports or in college. Make sure you are absolutely sure with your answers because interviewer is going to dig deep and cross question you.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Mentioned above.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Take Mock interviews with PGP2s if possible to have a context as in what can you expect there. For IT just be pretty much through your work-ex and you do not need any other preparation.

6. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   One of the best companies to work for in terms of work culture. You will get a lot of freedom to implement your own ideas but be rest assured IT in P&G will always be a supporting function and thus your voice might not reach to the top management unlike for marketing and sales people. Yes, they do roll out PPOs. In IT they gave PPO to 1 person out of 3.

Mondelez

Beauty Barman, IT Intern

1. **What was your role at Mondelez IT and what were the job responsibilities?**
   IT is a support vertical in Mondelez. I had to work in digitization of the supply chain and Change management.

2. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   GD- 1st step
   Interview- 2nd step, no pre-processing

3. **Does work experience matter?**
   For IT profile, work experience mattered. All those who were shortlisted had work experience.

4. **What kind of questions were you asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   The interview was mainly focussed on what you've done. You should be thorough with work experience and the major projects that you've done. They also asked about 'Favourite area in IT' and a few questions were related to that.

5. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Why Mondelez? Expectations from Mondelez?

6. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Prepare FMCG GDs, have idea about cloud, IOT and digital supply chain etc.

7. **How was the internship experience, work culture and PPO policy?**
   Experience was great, work culture even better. Yes, they have PPO policy though not declared as of now for IT.

Danaher

Madhusudan Kolhe, IT Intern

Work Ex: L&T (3 Years, Sales)

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.)**
   No GD, 2 rounds of interview, no case submissions, try to participate in their competition, if not, at least know about the competition

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Experience matters a little bit

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Work experience related, job responsibilities, biggest successes, and failures during this time, how did you go about failures, learning points from it; about Danaher- their business model, they asked a lot about acquisitions model of Danaher.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Walk me through your resume; success and failures, Why Danaher, Do you have any inputs for Danaher; Latest news about Danaher

5. **How do you recommend a PGP1 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   For preparation, follow their website, latest news, know about their business acquisition model (a lot of questions were based upon it); Attend their PPT; Participate in their case competition or at least know about the case.

6. **Any Feedback/comments for PGP1s:**
   Know every word of your resume.